

Kestrel Freight Cooperative - Staff Handbook, version 4.2 (effective 1 March 2026)

This handbook applies to every employee of Kestrel Freight Cooperative, in offices and in warehouses. Where a later entry in the Policy Change Log contradicts a value in this handbook, the change log prevails from its effective date.

1. Annual leave

Full-time employees receive 27 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, in addition to public holidays. Part-time employees receive leave pro rata to their contracted hours.

Up to 6 unused days may be carried over into the next year. Carried-over days must be used by 31 March of that year, after which they lapse without compensation.

Requests for a block of more than 5 consecutive working days must be submitted at least 14 calendar days in advance through the HR portal.

2. Sick leave

Employees may self-certify absence for up to 3 consecutive days. From the fourth day, a medical certificate is required and must reach HR within 2 working days.

3. Parental leave

Parents are entitled to 18 weeks of parental leave paid at 80% of base salary, which may be taken in up to three separate blocks before the child's third birthday.

4. Remote work

Employees in office roles may work remotely up to 2 days per week, agreed with their line manager. Warehouse operatives and drivers are not eligible for remote work.

Core hours for everyone working remotely are 10:00 to 15:30 Central European Time, during which the employee must be reachable.

5. Expenses

Expense claims must be submitted within 45 days of the expense. A receipt is required for every item above 25 EUR.

The daily meal allowance for domestic business travel is capped at 38 EUR per day. International meals are covered by the per diem in Travel Policy TP-7.

6. Probation and notice

The probation period is 4 months. During probation, either party may end employment with 2 weeks of notice. After probation the notice period is 3 months, or 4 months for people managers.

7. Speaking up

Concerns about fraud, safety or misconduct can be raised confidentially at ethics@kestrel.example. Reports are handled by the Compliance Officer, Ilse Varga, who acknowledges each report within 7 days.

8. Company vehicles

Company vans may only be driven by employees holding a category C1 licence for at least 2 years. Private use of company vehicles is not permitted.

9. Training

Every employee has an annual training budget of 1,150 EUR. Unused budget does not carry over. Forklift certification is renewed every 36 months and is paid by the company outside the personal budget.